

This patient guide provides initial education, practical protocols, and recovery management insight for common musculoskeletal conditions. Always consult your OrthoNow specialist for customized treatment pathways.

1. Managing Knee Pain

Knee pain can stem from acute injuries, overuse syndromes, or chronic degenerative changes. Understanding the presentation helps map the appropriate initial management strategies.

Common Triggers

- **Patellofemoral Pain:** Dull ache around the kneecap, worse with stairs.
- **Meniscal Tears:** Mechanical catching, locking, or sharp pain during twisting.
- **Osteoarthritis:** Gradual onset stiffness, morning aching, and localized swelling.

Immediate Care Rules

- **Activity Modification:** Swap high-impact running or jumping for swimming or cycling.
- **Joint Support:** Utilize a compression sleeve to improve proprioception and decrease effusion.

2. Back Pain & Lumbar Care

Mechanical lower back pain affects most individuals at some point. Proper biomechanics and early relative mobility are vital to preventing acute pain from turning chronic.

Postural Guidelines

- **Active Sitting:** Keep knees at 90 degrees, feet flat on the floor, and utilize a supportive lumbar roll.
- **Lifting Mechanics:** Always bend from hips and knees rather than bending the spine. Keep objects near the chest.

Core Stabilization

- Avoid prolonged bed rest; gentle walking promotes disc hydration and tissue movement.
- Incorporate low-impact core bracing exercises like the bird-dog or pelvic tilts as tolerated.

Red Flag Warning: Seek immediate medical care if back pain is accompanied by progressive leg weakness, numbness in the saddle region, or sudden bowel/bladder changes.

3. Acute Sports Injuries

Whether dealing with a ligamentous ankle sprain, a muscular hamstring strain, or tendon pain, rapid initial intervention sets the stage for a shorter recovery timeline.

The PRICE Protocol

- **Protect:** Splint, brace, or use crutches to shield the injured tissue.
- **Rest:** Avoid activities that recreate structural pain.
- **Ice:** Apply cold packs for 15-20 mins every 2-3 hours.

Compression & Elevation

- **Compress:** Wrap with an elastic bandage from distal to proximal to control swelling.
- **Elevate:** Position the injured limb comfortably above heart level whenever resting.

4. Universal Recovery Tips

Optimal orthopedic healing relies heavily on systemic factors that facilitate metabolic tissue repair and cellular synthesis.

- ✓ **Structured Progression:** Never rush back into sports. Progress gradually from range of motion, to targeted strength, to sport-specific coordination drills.
- ✓ **Anti-Inflammatory Nutrition:** Fuel tissue synthesis with lean proteins, omega-3 fatty acids, and vibrant antioxidants while maintaining optimal hydration.
- ✓ **Sleep Architecture:** Target 7-9 hours of restorative sleep nightly; human growth hormone (HGH) secretion peaks during deep sleep cycles, accelerating cellular healing.

Thank you for choosing OrthoNow.